

THE MAIN QUEST · FIELD GUIDE

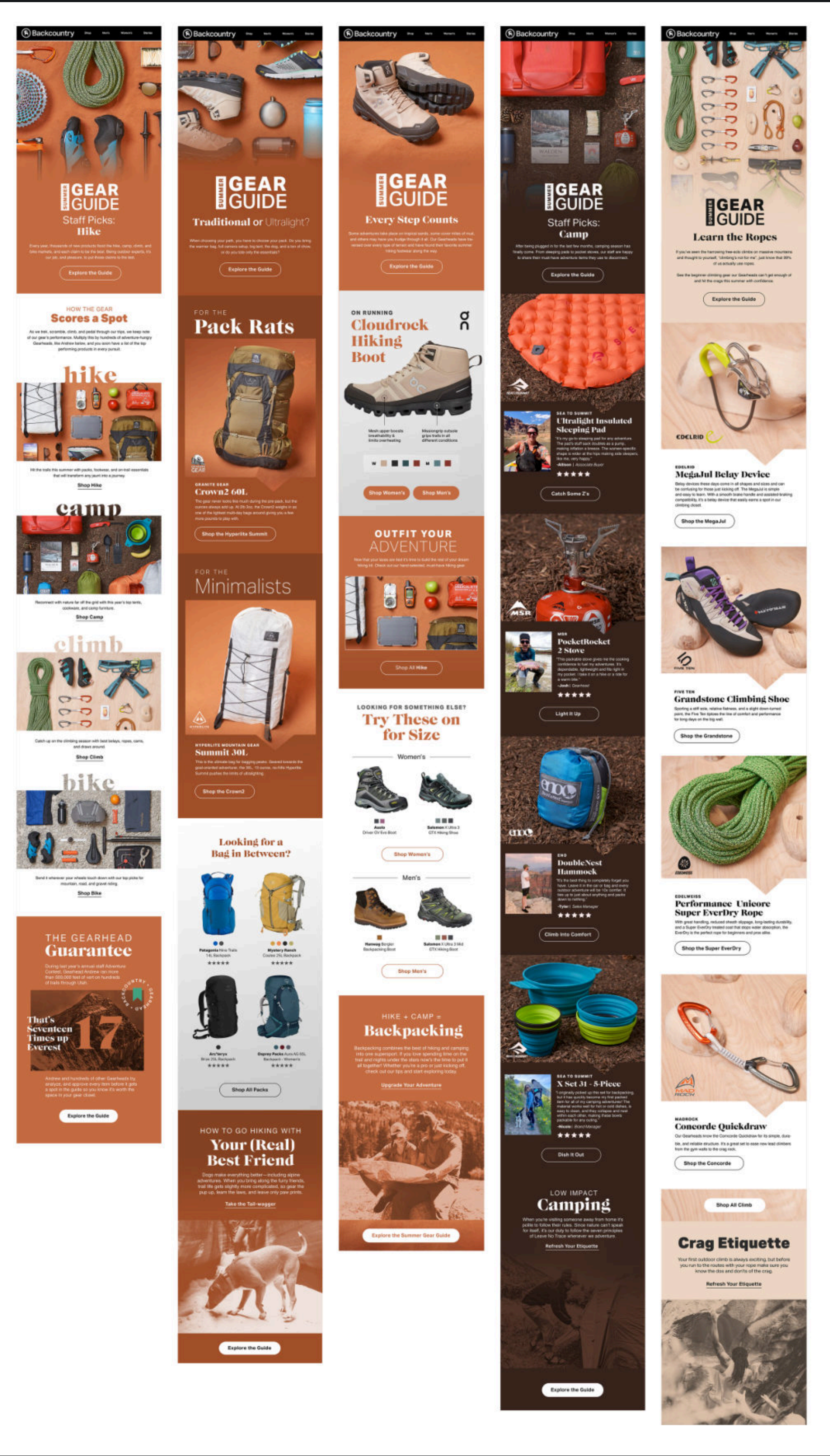
STORIES

The writing behind the work - across every medium: email, film, social, and more.

ALEX MOLISKI · BACKCOUNTRY

Email

Backcountry's email list is in the tens of millions - customers from every walk of life, each chasing their own pursuit. I've written thousands of emails: summer gear guides, winter layering deep-dives, product launches, and personal notes straight from me. A few of my favorites:



Sender Name: Backcountry | Gearhead Alex
SL1: How's your summer been?
PH1: A few of my trips I'd love to share with ya



A Packed Summer

My wife and I try to top our “totally miles hiked” every year. Last year, we hit 315, so we’ve had to lace up more than ever.

Instead of just grinding out the local trails every day, we try to aim for bucket-list-worthy hikes, and ooooh boy did we check some things off this summer.

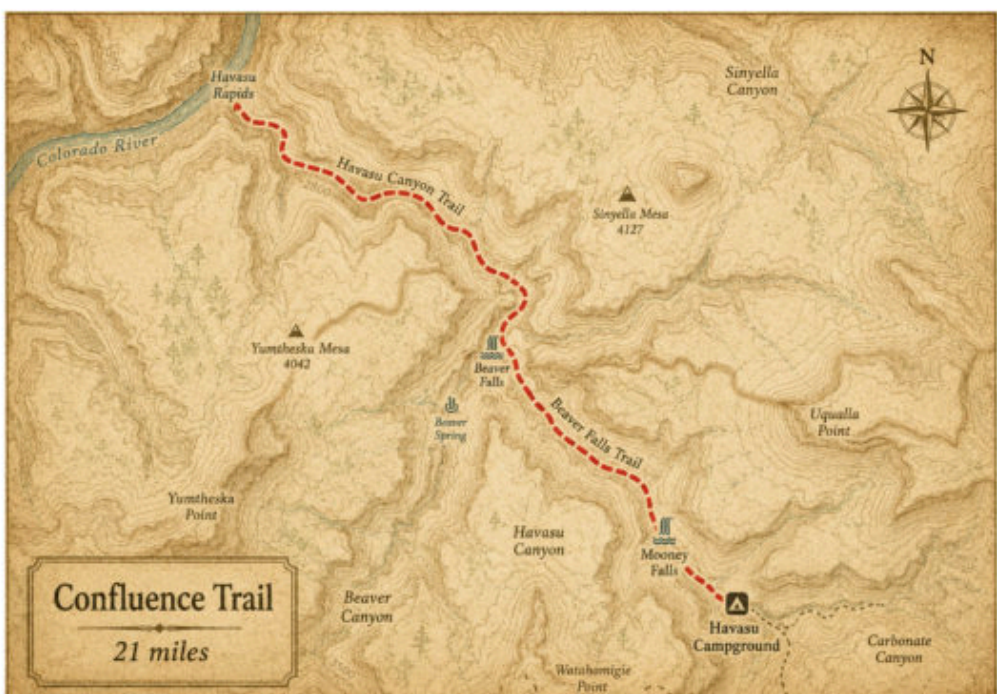


NICE WATERFALLS, HELLUVA HIKE

Havasupai

After years of trying, I snagged a permit to stay in Havasupai for four days. It was the trip of a lifetime.

Everyone talks about the amazing blue waterfalls (and for a good reason). But I rarely hear anything about hiking there.



It's a 10-mile hike just to reach the campground, and if you're ambitious, another 20 miles (round trip) to reach the confluence (aka: bottom of the Grand Canyon). We went for it all, and stacked up over 50 miles in 3.5 days.

Sore souls, healed soul. *Huge thank you to the Tribe for allowing visitors to enjoy this truly special place.*



FORTY MILES FOR A FISH

Titcomb Basin

Wyoming's Wind River Range has to be a top 3 favorite area of mine for backpacking.

Endless trails, towering peaks, blue lakes, and lots of trout (allegedly). I wanted to catch the Wind River Grand Slam (not a real thing) a cutthroat, brookie, rainbow, and the elusive golden.

After hiking 40 miles and fishing for 25+ hours. I caught ONE damn fish. The heat is keeping the fish too deep. Still, Titcomb basin was world-class.



CATCH YOU ON THE MOUNTAIN,
GEARHEAD ALEX

Sender Name: Backcountry | Gearhead Alex
SL1: I'm sending this to you from the desert 🏜️
PH1: Your resident Gearhead who's getting out



Dispatch From The Desert

I've been firing off a lot of deal emails lately, so I figured I'd switch it up with a little dispatch from the desert.

Right now, I'm living out of my 35-year-old van, chasing this stretch of perfect spring weather. During the day, I'm doing my best to get you dialed with the right gear. But once the laptop snaps shut? I'm off on a desert mission.



LIFE FROM THE BACKCOUNTRY

Real Gear. Real Days.

Spring's knocking, which means camping season isn't far behind. I wanted to make sure the gear I'm pitching you actually earns its spot. Here are a few of my favorites so far.

- **Coffee paste:** A little weird? Yes. But it works. I'll save it for backpacking and use my [VSSL](#) next time for the van.
- **A good cooler:** Soup's great most nights. But that steak over the fire on day five? Elite.
- **Portable power:** I couldn't work from the backcountry without a battery. It's a funny contradiction... living off-grid still takes tech.



When I wasn't working, I was hiking, metal detecting for old relics (by relics I mean trash), panning for gold, fishing, and biking until sunset.

Not a bad way to “test” the gear.

Thanks snow (when you came), but I'm excited for some warmer days. What about you?



CATCH YOU ON THE MOUNTAIN,
GEARHEAD ALEX

ALL-NEW EXCLUSIVE COLLECTION

HOLA

FROM PLAYA POPOYO

When we think of surfing close to home, California usually comes to mind first. We wanted to mix it up, so we hopped on a plane... to Nicaragua.

2,500 miles south later, we traded Utah's dusty deserts for the tree-lined coast of Playa Popoyo.

After an inspiring surf sesh and some playing on the playa, we teamed up with Popoyo locals to create more than just good memories.

BACKCOUNTRY X POPOYO SURF CLUB T-SHIRT

SNAG YOURS →

SHOP ALL POPOYO SURF TEES

Backcountry

Shop Men's Women's Sale

Backcountry Beacon

VOL. 11

Shy on the fly

There's nothing more meditative than casting a fly on a rushing river, and there's nothing more exhilarating than hooking and landing a big one.

Backcountry's newest athlete **Shyanne Orvis** claims that fly fishing offers more than a space to enjoy nature, it offers a space to heal. Follow Shyanne and a crew of all-women anglers on their reflective (and fish-filled) journey down the Green River in **Venture Beyond Ep. 3**.

Watch Now

GOAT NOTES

Fly Fishing Tips For Beginners

From the outside, fly fishing can be intimidating. There's the setup, choosing a (very) specific fly, and of course, the cast. Don't get bogged down in details—here are our tips for casting your first fly.

PRACTICE YOUR CAST

Tip 1: Dial your cast before dashing to the river. In other words, do a dry run before getting your line wet!

HAVE THE RIGHT TOOLS

Tip 2: If you thought toddlers were picky just wait till you try for trout. Having the right flies for your area is a must. Talk to a local or do some research before investing.

Hooked? Get 5 more tips here.

READ ON →

THE BACKCOUNTRY PODCAST

Episode 7: Shy On The Fly

Calling All Women Anglers

World traveler, fly fishing guru, recent mother, and our newest Backcountry Athlete, Shyanne Orvis, is trying to change the tides of fishing and get more women hooked on what she calls the most "therapeutic" and "rejuvenating" sport out there.

Watch Here

Shy's Picks

Gear For Landing Hogs

1

Fishpond
NOMAD NET

EXTENDED NET SIZE

"This is the only net I've ever owned. It's lightweight, easy to carry, and the long handle and extended net size make it a lot easier to land big fish on your own. There isn't a better net out there."

LEARN MORE →

2

Backcountry
TAHOE SUN HOODIE

BREATHABLE, COMFORTABLE, AND STRETCHY

"My newest favorite sun shirt. I have to be picky with sun shirts because I wear them all day, and this has passed the test. It's breathable, comfortable, and stretchy, which I LOVE!"

LEARN MORE →

3

TFO
AXIOM 2-X
ROD + CASE

GO-TO FAST-ACTION ROD

"This is my go-to fast-action rod that I use for targeting everything from trout to permit. It's a powerful rod that's capable of delivering long, accurate casts. And, it's absolutely beautiful."

LEARN MORE →

TROPHY CATCHES

Gearheads Getting Out

Trout—and other species—watch out! Backcountry Gearheads are angling all over Utah and beyond to try for trophy fish. Which angler has the best grip 'n' grin?

Film

Fewer readers, more viewers. The writing went from book to script. I've scripted a dozen-plus films: ski movies, documentaries, and ads watched by millions.



Pacing the Pacific (click to watch)



Venture Beyond - Mind the Gap (click to watch)



Venture Beyond - Taming the Wolverine (click to watch)
ALSO: SHORT-FORM OTT ADS



Ski the Day (click to watch)